

INTERNSHIP REPORT

Organization: CRY – Child Rights and You

Intern Name: Mishika Khanna

Program: Integrated Programme in Management (IPM), Year 2

Institution: Indian Institute of Management

Internship Duration: 5th June 2025 – 3rd July 2025

Total Duration: 4 Weeks

Acknowledgement

I would like to express my sincere gratitude to **Ms. Smriti Rustagi**, my mentor during the course of this internship at CRY – Child Rights and You. Her guidance, encouragement, and unwavering support played a pivotal role in shaping my experience. She has been consistently approachable, extremely helpful, and always willing to provide clarity whenever required.

Her mentorship not only helped me understand my responsibilities more effectively but also gave me the confidence to handle real-world coordination and communication tasks with professionalism. I am truly thankful for her patient supervision and valuable insights throughout the internship.

1. Introduction

As a second-year student of the Integrated Programme in Management (IPM) at the Indian Institute of Management, I undertook a four-week internship at CRY – Child Rights and You, one of India's most respected non-governmental organizations working towards ensuring children's rights. The internship provided a valuable opportunity to understand the functional and operational aspects, going beyond conventional corporate social responsibility (CSR) exposure and into broader themes of development, engagement, and administration.

2. Objectives of the Internship

- To gain firsthand experience in the operations of a leading NGO with a focus on child rights and development.
- To understand the intersection of CSR with field implementation, outreach, and administrative coordination.
- To enhance technical and interpersonal skills through hands-on responsibilities.
- To develop an understanding of structured communication, people coordination, and data management.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

a. Intern Communication and Coordination

I was actively involved in calling and coordinating with over 165 students who had applied to the CRY internship program. My tasks included:

- Conducting initial outreach calls to explain the internship structure, roles, and expectations.
- Managing follow-ups to ensure timely submissions and onboarding formalities.

- Resolving applicant queries professionally and documenting interactions to ensure consistent communication.
- Designing and maintaining an organized communication schedule to avoid redundancies.

This experience strengthened my ability to communicate with diverse stakeholders and improved my confidence in handling large-scale coordination independently.

b. Interviewing and Profiling Intern Applicants

I conducted and recorded over 125 interviews with potential interns. Each interview involved collecting and updating critical details such as:

- Academic and personal backgrounds
- Areas of interest, skills, and motivation to work with CRY
- Availability, preferred roles, and prior volunteering experience

This structured interviewing experience helped enhance my interpersonal skills and introduced me to techniques of human resource screening, empathy-based questioning, and clarity in data extraction.

c. Excel-Based Documentation and Database Management

My internship involved maintaining detailed records of intern data in Microsoft Excel. I was responsible for:

- Creating and managing a central database to track communications and application status
- Applying Excel functions for filtering, cross-verification, and progress monitoring
- Ensuring data accuracy and confidentiality through systematic documentation practices

This component provided me with real-time experience in administrative efficiency, technical skill enhancement, and organizational record-keeping.

4. Exposure Beyond CSR

Though initially assigned to administrative functions, my internship experience extended into learning about the larger developmental impact of CRY's work. I attended briefings and sessions on CRY's thematic focus areas, which included:

- Child education and retention in school
- Eradication of child labour and early marriage
- Community mobilization and capacity building
- Volunteer engagement and awareness campaigns

These sessions offered a deeper understanding of how policy advocacy, grassroots implementation, and volunteerism work in tandem within the nonprofit ecosystem. I also observed how CSR is only a part of the broader objective of sustainable community-led change.

5. Key Learnings and Outcomes

- **Professional Communication:** Improved ability to communicate clearly, respectfully, and efficiently with over 165 applicants
- **Follow-Up and Time Management:** Developed an organized approach to timely follow-ups and tracking large sets of information across stakeholders
- **Technical Proficiency:** Gained working knowledge of Microsoft Excel for data handling, which will be useful in academic and professional settings
- **Understanding of the Development Sector:** Learned about CRY's strategic priorities and the importance of rights-based approaches to development
- **Human Resource Sensitization:** Built a foundational understanding of applicant management, interviews, and talent coordination

6. Conclusion

My internship at CRY – Child Rights and You was an enriching experience that combined administrative responsibility with exposure to the social sector's core values. The opportunity to coordinate, interview, and communicate with over 165 applicants gave me a practical understanding of intern management, while my engagement with the organization's mission helped me reflect on the larger purpose of development work.

This experience not only sharpened my managerial and interpersonal skills but also reaffirmed my interest in impact-driven institutions that work at the intersection of business, policy, and social change. I look forward to applying these learnings in both academic and professional environments going forward.
